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First Quarter

In Oregon, we want everyone in our communi

ty to have an emergency kit that can sustain them for up to two weeks in case of emergency. This can seem like a daunting task for many people, so we've broken down what needs to be in an emergency kit and put together a plan to help you get fully stocked and prepared over the

course of one year. This guide provides you with a weekly breakdown of emergency supplies to help you get prepared. You can add an item each week, check in monthly to see what you need, or look over what we suggest you pack for each quarter of the year. Let's get started

with the first quarter, or the supplies you should put together in the first three months of building your 2-Week Ready Emergency Kit.

Week 1

Water

For our prepare in 1 year #prep1yr campaign, we want to give a few suggestions, tips and tricks to hopefully simplify the process and break down the needs for each item in your preparedness kit. Let’s start with one of the more essentials to plan for in an emergency – water.

We regularly get questions about water, including how much you should store for an emergency, and where should you store it.

Let’s break it down: During an emergency, every person should have access to one gallon of water per day. Using a family of 4, with no animals, as an example, you'll need to store 56 gallons of water for a 2-week preparedness kit.

One gallon equals 7 and a half 16.9-ounce bottles. To store the recommended amount, you would need 375 water bottles. A case of

24 bottles is 10" x 16" x 8" to store. You will need 15.5 cases for enough water for your family. Instead of doing all the math and trying to store that many cases of water, think about investing in a water purification unit. While they do cost more than purchasing just the bottles, they are easier to store. If you have a water source, you will have purified water. Be sure to keep extra filters on hand, some only last up to 40-50 gallons. If you have animals, you will need to store more water for them as well.

Filtered water vs. purified water vs. distilled water - what do you need to know?

Distilled water has the minerals and electrolytes removed. It is safe to drink but might taste flat or unlike most water you are used to drinking.

Filtered water has removed most harmful and toxic contaminates and is better for you than distilled water.

Purified water has a few added steps like reverse osmosis, distillation, or deionization; it's the step above filtered water. Unlike distilled water, it retains beneficial minerals and electrolytes.

Why do we have to store enough for 2 weeks? What happened to the 72-hour kit? Through geologist's research and the Oregon Resilience Plan, it's been projected that due to the amount of damage the Cascadia earthquake may cause, it could take up to 2-weeks for emergency professionals to reach your location. We need everyone to stay healthy until professional help can arrive. The 1 gallon per person per day guidelines cover hydration needs, as well as sanitation and cooking needs.

Week 2

Other Drinks

During an emergency, we want to have the comforts of home to get us through a devastating time. There are times we want more than just water. Keeping a supply of tea, coffee, soda, juice, and powered drink mixes will break up the monotony of just water. These are small items that have a long shelf life and are easy to store. They also provide

health benefits that include important minerals, vitamins, electrolytes and can give you energy when you need it.

Week 3

Cooking & Dish Washing

We are breaking down preparedness kits to make it simple for all and to explain the items in more detail and why you may want to consider adding them to your preparedness kits.

Let’s talk about cooking needs during an emergency.

While your stored canned goods may be fully cooked, you might not enjoy them if they’re cold. Other meals may require a heat source, so it’s important to plan how to cook food during an emergency. If you own camping equipment, you're likely 90% of the way done to prepping for your cooking needs. If you lose electricity, you can cook over an open fire, on a woodstove, or on a camping stove. Be sure to store all the utensils you'll need to cook - stir spoons, tongs, spatulas – in your emergency kit. These can all be purchased at a secondhand store or the Dollar Store if you want a separate set just for your emergency kit.

If cooking over an open fire or woodstove, be sure to have enough firewood on hand to keep the fire going for the 2-Weeks Ready preparedness goal.

Keep dishwashing supplies to go with your cooking supplies so you have everything you need to be prepared for two weeks. Dishwashing soap, washing bins, drying racks, and sponges can help keep your emergency kitchen going.

Week 4

Canned Meals

When considering food, choose items with a long shelf life, don't need much preparing or water to prepare, and are high in "energy calories" like proteins and carbohydrates, verses "empty calories" like candy. Canned stew, canned meats, beans, soup - these items are fully cooked and don't need water, or much water, to consume. If you don't

normally eat canned meats, don't purchase them for your kit! Keep food you will actually eat.
Peanut butter is a shelf stable choice and has a lot of protein and healthy fats.
Canned pastas and soups can feel like complete meals, or you can eat them with canned fruits and veggies or shelf-stable crackers or snacks to fill you up.
Instead of buying all your canned food at once, start by buying duplicates of canned food you already eat. You can rotate them in your pantry, so they never expire, and you'll have plenty on hand in case of an emergency.

Week 5

Canned Fruits and Vegetables

Canned fruits have liquid for hydration as well as canned vegetables. If you get them with flip top cans, you're a step ahead since you won't need a can opener. Keep in mind, fresh fruits and vegetables are not going to be an option for long-term storage.
While you can purchase frozen fruit and vegetables, if we don't have electricity, these items will thaw quickly; probably a good idea to eat those first and leave the canned food for later.
Fruits and vegetables are a staple in our diets; this will keep us healthy and give us energy when we need it most. While every family is different, we recommend having at least one can of fruits/veggies per person per day in your emergency supplies.

Week 6

Snacks

Let's keeping building your food supplies for your emergency kit. This week, we're talking about snacks. Your emergency food supplies should be shelf-stable, and a mix of meals and snacks to make sure you're eating enough food during an emergency. To that end, snacks that have lots of protein, fiber, and carbohydrates are great to keep on hand.

Protein bars are great to help keep you full, and they are usually smaller than canned goods. Protein powders work as well, but they need to be added to water so make sure to plan that into your water storage needs.
Dried fruits are shelf-stable and can be a tasty treat in your emergency kit. Applesauce or other pureed fruit also has a longer shelf life, but make sure you rotate it regularly into your normal snacks, so it does not go bad.
Crackers, nuts, and jerky are savory snacks that work well in emergency kits since they're shelf stable.
Above all, make sure the snacks you pack in your kit are ones you enjoy and will want to eat during an emergency. You can build up your snack storage through buying multiples of the snacks you already enjoy. You'll have plenty on hand in case of emergency, and you won't have to worry about them expiring before you get a chance to eat them.

Week 7

Tents, Camping Equipment & RVs

While we've been focusing on water and food, the other essential item during an emergency is shelter. Emergency professionals in Oregon are planning for how to respond the potential Cascadia Earthquake, and part of the predictions include widespread property damage. If an emergency causes your home to be unlivable, you need an alternative shelter in your emergency supplies.
Luckily, if you're like many Oregonians and enjoy camping, you likely already have the needed supplies for an emergency shelter. Camping supplies like tents, canopies, tarps, sleeping pads, and even RVs can be used as emergency shelter supplies. Keep these supplies together in an easily accessible place to use them for camping trips and/or emergency situations.
Hotels & motels may not be available, but you can still assemble a list of those in your area to see if they are safe. If you have animals, be sure to find ones that will accept pets.

Week 8

Heavy Tarps & Plastic Sheeting

Heavy tarps and plastic sheeting are great to pack in your kit to help with sheltering needs.
They can become a shelter when strung up or be placed over existing tents or shelters to help keep water out or as another layer for warmth. They can cover provide a quick fix to leaks or open spaces, keep you dry in a pinch, or be used to protect yourself from the elements.
Tarps are inexpensive and can go a long way in sheltering your family from the elements.

Week 9

Blankets & Bedding

Pack blankets, bedding, and other sleeping materials in your emergency kit. Sleeping bags are a good choice since they're made to keep you warm and can be packed into a small bundle. Mylar and emergency blankets are also good choices, as they are small to store in your kit. If you have camping supplies like cots, sleeping pads, or air mattresses, keep them with your emergency supplies as well.
These are bulky to store so try and use ones you already have. Lay the blanket or sleeping bag open on your bed, put as many supplies in it as possible – not too heavy, so you can still carry it, and you'll have bedding and clothing in one bundle.

Week 10

Clothing, Jackets & Boots

Keep a few changes of clothing for you and your family for emergencies. These clothes should be comfortable and easy to move in. Oregon has four distinct seasons, so you'll need to pack clothing that will work in a variety of weather. Pack tank tops, t-shirts, long sleeves, sweaters or hoodies, and a coat that can be layered as needed. Include a rain jacket or poncho to deal with the rain and

prioritize clothing that can be washed and dried quickly by hand. Don't forget undergarments and socks, as well as sturdy boots/shoes.

Week 11

Medications, Vitamins, Toothbrush & Toothpaste

Add medications, vitamins, a toothbrush, and toothpaste to your emergency kit. These can help you solve small medical problems and stay healthy during emergencies. Add over the counter medications like fever reducers, pain relievers, antihistamines, cold medicine, cough syrup, and any other types of medication you use regularly. Add vitamins to your kit as well to make sure you can still get valuable vitamins and minerals even if your food sources change.
If you take life-saving prescriptions, work with your health care provider to accumulate up to 2 weeks of extra medication for an emergency situation.

Week 12

Bungee Cords, Tie Downs & Duct Tape

Pack your 2-Weeks Ready Kit with supplies to help you secure or move items as needed in an emergency. Bungee cords, zip ties, cable ties, and duct tape are all multi-use items that you may need in an emergency.
These items can help tie down your needed supplies, especially tarps. Use them to secure items in your vehicle so items don’t blow away or get damaged in the sun or rain.

Week 13

Fire Supplies

Stock your 2-Weeks Ready kit with supplies to build and maintain a fire. Having a fire during emergencies can help you stay warm, cook food, sanitize water, or dry clothing. Designate a safe spot for a fire pit and have supplies available to make sure the fire will be contained.

Keep an axe, lighter or matches in a Ziplock bag, and extra wood with your emergency supplies.
Other things that can be used are fire pellets or Duraflame. Each log lasts up to 3 hours.

Second Quarter

You're well on your way to being ready for any emergency or disaster and building your 2-Week Ready Emergency Kit. Keep exploring this list and the emergen

cy prepared ness tips so you know what to do in case of an emergen cy in Marion County.

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Week 14

First Aid Kit

First aid kits can help you deal with injuries big and small during emergencies. You can build your own first aid kit with helpful supplies or purchase a pre-made one. Once you have your kit, make sure you know how to properly use all the supplies in it. If you have the time, consider taking a first aid class so you're prepared to use everything in your kit if necessary.

Some medical supplies have expiration dates, so make sure to check your first aid kit regularly and replace items as needed.

If you decide to build your own, you'll want various sizes of gauze pads, various sizes of bandages, disposable gloves, tweezers, scissors, alcohol-free cleansing wipes, and some with alcohol, medical tape, sunscreen, burn cream, bug spray, aspirin or ibuprofen, antihistamine cream or tablets, to name a few.

Week 15

Disaster Plan

Create a disaster plan to ensure you are 2-Weeks Ready to face emergencies. This plan should cover what emergencies you might have to face in Oregon, what your evacuation routes look like, how you will communicate in an emergency, how your family can reconnect if separated, and how specific needs in your family might change how you respond to emergencies.

This can seem overwhelming, but there are plenty of resources available to guide you and your family through the planning process. This FEMA form has guided questions to help you prepare your family for emergencies. It will prompt you to answer questions, and once you're done, a complete PDF plan will be emailed to you.

Week 16

Home Inventory

A home inventory is a document of all your belongings and the condition of your home as it is now, before any emergencies occur. Your inventory will help you prove the value of what you owned, which could speed your claim processing, and will provide documentation for tax deductions you can claim for your losses. An up-to-date inventory can also help you to determine the correct amount of insurance to purchase.

You can take photos or videos to help you record your belongings, but be sure to also write down descriptions, including year, make, and model numbers, where appropriate. For valuable items, you may want to have an appraisal to determine the item’s worth. Be sure to store your inventory somewhere it can be easily accessed after a disaster. Store paper copies in a waterproof and fireproof box, safe, or bank deposit box. Leave copies with trusted relatives or friends. Secure electronic copies with strong passwords and save them on a flash or external hard drive in your waterproof box or safe.

Week 17

Sanitation Supplies

Sanitation standards are important to maintain during emergencies as it keeps communities healthy and safe. If sewer systems are impacted, you need to have a system in place to properly contain and dispose of waste to prevent disease.

The Twin Bucket System is an affordable and simple option to deal with human waste when sewer systems are down. The key to this method is separating pee and poo. This lessens volume and odor, making bucket contents safer and easier to store and dispose of. This method is ideal for dense urban areas with limited open space and locations with a high-water table.

It's very hard to keep surfaces clean without running water. When using emergency toilets, it's important not to touch human poo or let it touch other objects. Any surface that may come into contact with poo (such as a toilet seat) should be made of a non-porous, non-absorbent material that can be easily disinfected.

Here's what you need in your kit to use the Twin Bucket System:

- **Two sturdy plastic (five or six gallon) buckets**. One marked PEE or #1 and one marked POO or #2.
- **A toilet seat.** You can adapt a regular toilet seat or buy a seat that is designed for use with buckets (available at most camping stores, emergency supply retailers, etc.). If you can, purchase two - many people prefer to sit when going pee. Do not use a pool noodle! They are absorbent and porous. They are impossible to fully clean, which increases the risk of spreading disease.
- **Layering material**. Carbon-based materials work best. It should be lightweight, dry, and organic. The goal is to absorb moisture, reduce odor, and deter flies. You'll need about a handful to cover each poo. Examples: sawdust, shredded paper, bark chips (avoid cedar), dry leaves, dry grass clippings, peat moss, toilet paper, hamster bedding, etc.

- **A roll or box of heavy-duty plastic garbage bags.** 13-gallon size, 0.9 mil or thicker.
- **Hand sanitizer or handwashing supplies** to use after each use.

Check out this resource for more information on emergency toilets and safe disposal methods during emergencies.

Week 18

Tools

It's important to establish shelter during an emergency. These can range from temporary tents to more permanent structures to returning to your home. Having tools available can help you establish shelter in an emergency, or make repairs as needed to keep your shelter safe. Here's a basic list to help you get started on your emergency tool kit:

- Hammer
- Nails in various sizes
- Screwdrivers
- Screws in various sizes
- Wrench
- Crowbar
- Wood cutting saw

Week 19

Flashlight, Lantern & Batteries

Visibility is important during an emergency, and flashlights and lanterns can help. Plan to pack multiple flashlights and lanterns, it's best to keep one per person in your kit and a few extras in easily accessible places in case you lose power unexpectedly.
Pack extra batteries or fuel for your flashlights and lanterns so they can keep running for at least two weeks. Check your batteries often because they expire and can become corroded.

Week 20

Personal Care Supplies

Just like when you pack for a trip, you need to pack personal care items for emergencies. Shampoo, conditioner, deodorant, lotion or moisturizer, and other personal care items are important to staying clean and healthy. You can put travel sized items in your kit to save space or use bars and tab versions of common items like shampoo or toothpaste to get lots of product without having to take up a lot of space.

Week 21

Feminine Hygiene Supplies

Emergencies can happen at any time, so make sure your kit has all the essential supplies you need for hygiene. If you use them during an emergency, make sure to dispose of them properly.

Week 22

Pet Essentials

Don't forget to prepare your pets for emergencies too! These members of the family will also need to have emergency supplies in the kit to make sure they are 2-Weeks Ready. Pack enough pet food for two weeks into your emergency kit and make note of the expiration dates. Depending on the size of the pet, you may need to add an additional gallon of water per day for them in your supplies. Pack food and water dishes as well as extra leashes, a pet carrier, and harnesses.

If your pet takes medication, make sure it's included in the emergency supplies. Talk with your vet about what to do in emergencies and if having extra medication for your kit is possible.

Don’t forget bedding and toys for comfort. If you’re upset with the situation, more than likely they are too.

Week 23

Gas & Water Shut Off

Locate your gas meter and water shut off points at your home. Make sure you know how to turn these utilities off if necessary, during an emergency. Store a wrench or shutoff tool near them so it's easily accessible.

Show all family members how to access the utility shut offs. Water shut off takes a special tool, be sure it will work instead of assuming a standard screwdriver will work. Natural gas must be turned back on by the company, not homeowners.

Week 24

Portable AM/FM Radio

While you might rely on your computer or smartphone to receive emergency notifications, portable radios are a great backup for emergencies. Keep a radio in your emergency kit so you can stay up to date on news during an emergency. We recommend a NOAA radio because you'll get up to date weather information and receive emergency alerts.

Week 25

Portable Charger & External Battery

Smartphones are useful tools since they can access emergency information and updates when you need them. To make sure they stay useful, pack a portable charger and/or external batteries in your kit to keep them powered. Car chargers are a good choice they can charge your phone while you’re on the go.

External batteries come in a variety of sizes, and some can charge phones and other devices multiple times on a single charge. If you purchase a larger external battery, pack extra cords for your devices so you don't have to hunt one down during an emergency. Check the

charge level regularly, most can hold theirs for 3-6 months before needing to be recharged if you don't use it in that time.
Label what each charger is for; this will come in handy in a stressful situation.

Week 26

Whistle & Pocketknife

These items may be small, but they make a mighty impact during an emergency. Whistles are great items to keep in your emergency kit, but you should also keep one by your bed or in other spaces where you spend a lot of time. If an earthquake occurs, you might become trapped in rubble until emergency services can rescue you. A whistle will let them know you need help and help them identify where you are if you're not visible.
Pocketknives have a variety of uses, especially if they come with multi-tools. Since they're useful in a pinch for so many tasks, keep one in your kit and one near where you spend lots of time so you can access it easily.

Third Quarter

Congratulations on making it over halfway in the

Emergency Preparedness in One Year challenge! We hope you continue to pack what you need for your 2-Week Ready Emergency Kit, and learn about how you can prepare yourself and your families for potential emergencies in Marion County.

Week 27

Soap

Don't underestimate the importance of staying clean, especially during an emergency. Pack soap in your kit to prevent sickness and stay clean. Bar soaps are a great option since they take up very little space in your kit. There are also bars for other personal care items, like shampoo, conditioner, and lotion. Pack enough in your kit to last you and your family two weeks, and plan for multiple uses like bathing, hand washing, and spot cleaning. Soap is inexpensive and you'll be thankful you have it on hand.

Week 28

Paper Products

Paper products have multiple uses in your 2-Weeks Ready kit and can be especially useful if you're trying to conserve water. Paper towels and napkins can help with cleaning needs, paper plates and bowls can reduce how many dishes you need to wash, and toilet paper is self-explanatory but too vital to forget to add to the list.
Disposing of waste may be more difficult during an emergency, so it's a good idea to have durable options to go with the disposable ones in your kit.

Week 29

Water Purification Equipment

People can only survive three days without water, so it's important to pack your emergency kit with supplies to help you keep water sources clean and safe to drink. Here is more information on water purification to help you purify water in an emergency.
Filters - keep water filters, coffee filters, or clean cloths in your emergency kit to help with water filtration. Disinfecting techniques are more effective after water has been filtered to remove pollutants.

Disinfection methods - pack bleach, iodine, or water disinfection tablets in your emergency kit. Keep a dropper with these supplies to make it easy to measure out the correct amount of disinfectant per gallon of water.
Clean containers - pack pots, pans, cans, and other clean containers to boil and store your clean water once it's been disinfected.

Week 30

Water Purification Techniques

Water is one of the most important parts of an emergency kit. Having enough water on hand for two weeks for you and your family might be a challenge, so we want to share some more water purification techniques. Water purification is important to reduce and remove the number of suspended particles, parasites, algae, viruses, bacteria, and fungi that may harbor inside the water.

Boiling

Boiling water is a tried-and-true method to make it safe to drink. Bring it to a rolling boil for at least one minute and let cool. If the water is still cloudy after boiling, you can run it through a clean cloth or coffee filter to remove additional pollutants.

Bleach

Only use regular, unscented chlorine bleach products that are suitable for disinfection and sanitization as indicated on the label. The label may say that the active ingredient contains 6 or 8.25% of sodium hypochlorite. Do not use scented, color safe, or bleaches with added cleaners. If water is cloudy, let it settle and filter it through a clean cloth, paper towel, or coffee filter.

Locate a clean dropper from your medicine cabinet or emergency supply kit. Locate a fresh liquid chlorine bleach or liquid chlorine bleach that is stored at room temperatures for less than one year. As a general guide, use 8 drops of 6% bleach, or 6 drops of 8.25% bleach, to each gallon of water. Double the amount of bleach if the water is cloudy, colored, or very cold. Stir and let stand for 30 minutes. The water should have a slight chlorine odor. If it doesn’t, repeat the

dosage and let stand for another 15 minutes before use. If the chlorine taste is too strong, pour the water from one clean container to another and let it stand for a few hours before use.

Iodine

You may have iodine in your medicine cabinet or first aid kit. Add five drops of 2% tincture of iodine to each quart or liter of water that you are disinfecting. If the water is cloudy or colored, add 10 drops of iodine. Stir and let the water stand for at least 30 minutes before use.

Water Disinfection Tablets

You can disinfect water with tablets that contain chlorine, iodine, chlorine dioxide, or other disinfecting agents. These tablets are available online or at pharmacies and sporting goods stores. Follow the instructions on the product label as each product may have a different strength.

Steam / Evaporation Stills

This method involves taking moist materials and collecting the condensation using a tarp/plastic, a rock, and a bowl.

Week 31

Medical Equipment

If you use any medical equipment, you should make a plan for what to do in an emergency. Most medical equipment requires power, so include batteries or external power sources for your medical equipment. If there is a travel-version of your equipment, consider keeping it in your kit for emergencies.

If you take medications, talk with your medical provider about what you can do in an emergency. If any of your medication requires refrigeration, keep ice packs and a cooler available for your medication in an emergency.

Week 32

Sunscreen

Keep sunscreen in your emergency kit to protect yourself from the elements. The last thing you want to deal with during an emergency is a

sunburn, so make sure your kit is stocked with sunscreen to prevent burns if you must spend time outside and in the heat. Sunscreens can expire, so keep an eye on the expiration date and replace it as needed.

Week 33

Cleaning Supplies

Keeping your spaces clean is important to staying healthy during an emergency. Pack cleaning supplies in your emergency kit to make sure you can properly clean your items to reuse them and keep your spaces free from dirt and germs. Pack items like multi-purpose cleaner or wipes for spills or messes, laundry detergent that works in machines and with handwashing, dishwashing soap, and any other supplies you normally use to clean and disinfect your spaces.

Week 34

Make a Plan for Earthquakes

The State of Oregon is working to get everyone prepared for a potential 9.0+ magnitude earthquake caused by the Cascadia Subduction Zone. Since earthquakes can happen at any time, it's valuable to plan how you'll respond in a variety situations.

What to do BEFORE an Earthquake

Secure large items in your home like bookshelves, picture frames, ceiling fans, and other items near where you spend time like your bed or living room.

Pack a go kit to keep near your bed in case an emergency occurs in the middle of the night. Keep sturdy shoes, a flashlight, a whistle, and a pair of glasses if you need them in this bag. Tie the bag to your bedframe so you it's easily accessible.

What to do DURING an Earthquake

Drop, cover, and hold on! Find sturdy furniture like desks or tables to take cover. Once you're there, cover your head and hold on until the shaking stop. Be warry of potential aftershocks before you leave your shelter.

What to do AFTER an Earthquake

Check in with your family to make sure everyone is okay and accounted for, including your pets. Check to see if your home is safe, or if you'll need to find alternate shelter. Plan for how you'll access your essential items and go bags, and think about what you cannot leave home without.
Check on your neighbors, and establish a neighborhood meeting area. This is a good opportunity to discuss who needs help, and what supplies are available to help them.

Week 35

Personal Protective Equipment

Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) is an umbrella term for any supplies that can keep you safe and healthy during an emergency. Keep items like gloves, masks, safety glasses, reflective vests or clothing, and sturdy clothes and shoes in your emergency to help keep you safe.
You may also consider a hard hat or some type of helmet, or a more advanced form of PPE like a Tyvek suit.

Week 36

Garbage Bags

While most of us don't think much about our garbage once it's on the curb, it's an essential service to keeping our community clean and healthy. During an emergency, garbage service might be interrupted or delayed. It's important to keep your space clean and free of trash, and to safely contain it until you can dispose of it properly. Pack garbage bags of multiple sizes in your emergency kit to keep your trash contained and your space clean during an emergency.

Week 37

Sewing Kit

An item that is sometimes overlooked is a sewing kit. You can purchase a travel sewing kit or make one yourself with some of the

repair essentials like needles, thread, buttons, and clothing patches. Sewing kits can help you make small repairs to your clothing, allowing the minimal clothing supplies packed into your kit to last you the full two weeks and then some.
A sewing kit can also mend stuffed toys for kids or pets.

Week 38

Baby Items

If you have a baby or small child at home, put together the supplies they would need to be 2-Weeks Ready. Add items like formula, food, diapers, wipes, clothing, anything that your child might need. Keep updating these items as they grow and develop so your kit is always packed with supplies to help during an emergency. These items should be rotated on a regular basis.

Week 39

Additional Pet Supplies

Don't forget about your furry family members when get 2-Weeks Ready. You should have already packed up food, water, and medication for your pets, but today we're encouraging you to add additional supplies they may need.
Items like collars/harnesses, leashes, waste bags or cat litter, toys or comfort items, and crates or carriers are also important to pack up for your pet in case of an emergency. This is also a good opportunity to research pet-friendly sheltering options. During emergencies, some shelters and/or hotels do not accept pets, so plan ahead to know where your pet will be welcome if you must evacuate.
For those who have livestock; you'll need a way to transport them to a safe area. If you don't have the ability, maybe a friend, family member, or a neighbor can assist. Make these plans in advance so you can count on it.

Fourth Quarter

You're almost finished with the Emergency Preparedness in One Year challenge! By now, you are well on your way to being ready for emergencies and disasters in Marion County with your 2-Week Ready Emergency Kit.

Complete these final preparedness tips to make sure you and your family are ready to go.

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Week 40

Camp Kitchen

Put together supplies to build an emergency camp kitchen. Camp kitchens describe a common set up for cleaning dishes and other supplies when you don't have access to running water or a sink. You should have three basins for your kitchen, one that you fill with warm and soapy water for cleaning; one with cold water to rinse; and a final one with water and bleach to disinfect. Once they've gone through the basins, place them on a drying rack or dry them so they're ready to use again.

Week 41

Item Storage

Now that you've been collecting your emergency supplies for most of the year, it's time to think about how you want to store them so they're ready in case of emergency. Some of the biggest components to consider when selecting your item storage are visibility, mobility, and protection from the elements.

You want your emergency kit supplies to be in a visible container so you can always find items, even after a major emergency or disaster.

You should clearly label your supplies, so you know exactly where your supplies are when you need them.
If possible, your emergency supplies should be kept in a container that can move in case you need to evacuate your home. Large suitcases with wheels might work well for some of your supplies, or even garbage bins on wheels can work to store your supplies and move them as needed.
You also want to look for storage solutions that take weather into account. Oregon is known for rainy winters, so waterproof containers are a good idea. Many plastic boxes are waterproof, and keep your supplies dry no matter where you store them.

Week 42

Eating Utensils

While it may not immediately come to mind when thinking about emergency preparedness, eating utensils are an important part of your kit. It's best to keep two types of utensils on hand - durable and disposable. The durable option can be washed and reused without creating extra waste. If your source of water is limited though, disposable options can help you conserve water while still allowing you to eat your meals.
These are easy to accumulate; if you order take out from home, keep the disposable utensils provided in a zip lock bag and add them to your supplies.

Week 43

Can Opener

Keep a manual can opener in your kit to open your canned food during an emergency. Best case, look for pull top cans for easier access. A can opener usually has a bottle opener on it too.

Week 44

Cooler

Pack a cooler with your emergency supplies so you can keep food cold during an emergency. Ice may be difficult to come by during an emergency, so make sure you have plenty of ice packs in your freezer or invest in an iceless cooler.

As a rule, during a power outage you should keep your refrigerator and freezer closed to keep temperatures cooler for longer. Your refrigerator can keep food cold at safe temperatures for around 4 hours with the doors closed. If the power remains out after this time, transfer your food to coolers to keep it cool at safe temperatures. A full freezer can keep its temperature for about 48 hours. Keep track of food temperatures, and if anything reaches over 40 degrees, it may no longer be safe to eat.

Some homeowner's insurance could help you replace items that were lost. Keep an inventory of what was discarded and call your homeowners insurance to see what they can provide; especially if it’s medication that must stay refrigerated.

Week 45

Rope

Rope is another multi-use item that's great to keep your emergency supplies. It could hold down items when you load up a car or truck, be tied to trees for a clothesline or barrier, or pull someone to safety. Pack heavy duty rope so it can handle anything you throw at it.

Week 46

Knives

Knives can have multiple uses in an emergency, and you should keep a few different types in your kit to help you be prepared. Pack camping knives, utility knives, and/or kitchen knives in your emergency kit.

Knives can be used for a variety of tasks, but make sure you store them safely in your kit.

Week 47

Pliers & Vise Grips

Pliers and vise grips, like other tools, can be useful in an emergency. They can help you turn off utilities, make repairs, or help you get a strong grip on whatever you need to work on. Keep these with the other tools in your emergency kit.

If using to turn off utilities, be sure the tool fits the need; you don't want to find out during an emergency that it doesn't work. Use this week to test out the fit as well as pack up the tools.

Week 48

Games and Entertainment Items

Pack games and entertainment items in your emergency kit to help pass the time and keep your family calm during an emergency. Sometimes after a big emergency, you'll need to pass the time until everything returns to normal. Pack a deck of cards, board games, puzzles, or any other activity that does not require electricity or a lot of space to enjoy.

If you have children, consider packing coloring books, small toys, or comfort items to help them during emergencies.

Week 49

Fire Extinguisher

Keep a fire extinguisher with your emergency supplies. Class ABC fire extinguishers are a great choice because they can quickly put out fires from trash/paper/wood, liquids and gasses, and electrical sources. Fire extinguishers have a long shelf life but check yours regularly, so it does not expire.

If you keep it with your other emergency supplies, make sure you can grab it easily to respond to a fire quickly. Otherwise, keep it near places

that are most likely to have fire dangers. Learn how to use it and be sure all family members are educated as well.

Week 50

Packing & Preservation Supplies

Since this emergency kit will help you be 2-Weeks Ready, add supplies to help you pack and preserve items as needed during those two weeks. Plastic wrap, resealable bags, tin foil, and other storage supplies can be useful during an emergency. They can keep unfinished food wrapped up to help extend your food supplies or secure small items.

Week 51

What can I do to help, or how do I get help during an emergency?

If you're wondering what you can do to help your family and community think of it like a target; start with those in your own home, and make sure everyone is ok, then start moving out to your neighborhood and then beyond. Work to build a team with others to check on the neighborhood, share resources, and work to help everyone as you move further away from your home. Eventually points of distribution will be established, and others will need help getting additional food, water, medical help, or evacuation, be part of the help.

One big thing anyone can help with is trying to make sure the roads are clear for vehicles to get down. Clearing tree limbs, pavement, rocks, and debris to be able to get vehicles moving will help with medical and general supplies or evacuation.

If you know you'll need help, work to build your team and relationships before an incident. During an emergency, ask for help, and let people know your needs. There may be professionals in your area that can help you in the aftermath of an incident.

Week 52

What happens next?

This is a question we often overlook when we talk about building a kit and getting prepared. I'm two weeks ready, what happens after two weeks? Ideally, we'll have responders from all over the world coming to help, realistically, you should plan on how you'll start rebuilding or stabilizing your home as a place you can live (if you don't plan to evacuate and leave).

How will you get back to cooking in your kitchen, sleeping in your bed, and keeping your house from being impacted by the Oregon weather. We recommend people look at how they would cover their windows or doors, how you might cover your roof if damaged (Tarps, Plastic Sheeting, Plywood etc.). Ultimately, you'll want to live in your home as long as possible, the recovery of big emergencies can take years (homes are still being rebuilt after the 2020 fires).

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Thank you for taking the time to prepare yourself and your family for emergencies in Marion County.

For more emergency

prepared ness tips and informati on for Marion County, check out our website and follow us on social media.

If you'd like to receive tips and updates right to your inbox, sign up now for our digital newsletter! We'll share these tips

throughout the year to help you get 2-Weeks Ready.